

English Grammar: Sentence Correction Guide

Educational Series

December 29, 2025

1 Subject-Verb Agreement

The verb must agree with its subject in number and person.

- **Rule 1:** When two subjects are joined by *and*, they take a plural verb. (e.g., Gold and silver **are** precious metals).
- **Rule 2:** If two nouns suggest one idea or refer to the same person/thing, use a singular verb. (e.g., Bread and butter **is** his only food).
- **Rule 3:** Words joined to a singular subject by *with*, *as well as*, or *along with* do not change the number of the subject. (e.g., The captain, with all his men, **was** drowned).

2 Noun-Related Corrections

- **Uncountable Nouns:** Words like *furniture*, *scenery*, *information*, *advice*, *poetry*, *luggage* are always singular.
 - *Incorrect:* The furnitures are old.
 - *Correct:* The **furniture is** old.
- **Plural in Form, Singular in Meaning:** *Mathematics*, *News*, *Ethics*, *Politics*, *Billiards*.
 - *Incorrect:* Mathematics are difficult.
 - *Correct:* Mathematics **is** difficult.

3 Pronoun Errors

- **Case after 'Than':** Use subjective case for comparison.
 - *Incorrect:* He is faster than me.
 - *Correct:* He is faster than **I**.
- **Each/Every/Neither:** These always take singular verbs and singular pronouns.
 - *Incorrect:* Each of the students have their own pen.
 - *Correct:* Each of the students **has** his/her own pen.

4 Adjective and Degree Errors

- **Double Comparatives:** Do not use "more" with "-er" adjectives.
 - *Incorrect:* This is more better.
 - *Correct:* This is **better**.
- **Latin Adjectives:** *Senior, Junior, Superior, Inferior* take **to**, not *than*.
 - *Incorrect:* He is senior than me.
 - *Correct:* He is senior **to** me.

5 Tense Consistency

- **Universal Truths:** Always remain in the Simple Present tense, regardless of the principal clause.
 - *Incorrect:* The teacher said that the earth revolved around the sun.
 - *Correct:* The teacher said that the earth **revolves** around the sun.

6 Practice Exercises

1. *Error:* One must finish his work on time.
Correction: One must finish **one's** work on time.
2. *Error:* I, you and he are friends.
Correction: **You, he and I** are friends. (Order 2-3-1 for positive context).
3. *Error:* Many a man have died of hunger.
Correction: Many a man **has** died of hunger.